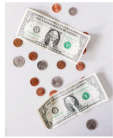


Farmers and the Populist Movement

Follow along with the presentation and read the sections when you get to those questions. You may use bullet points, but be sure you have a complete answer.

What are some issues/problems farmers faced in the late 1800s in the United States?	Brainstorm some ideas with your group.
Economics Nationwide  • Greenbacks? • put into circulation and increased money supply • Paper Money • Not Hard Money-backed by coin • Farmers took out loans during this time • Problem with greenbacks? Could not be exchanged for gold or silver. Was worth less than hard \$ • When government took back the greenbacks after the Civil War, people had to pay back loans in more expensive money  	Are Greenbacks <u>real</u> money?
Money Supply   	What happens to prices when there is a lot of money in the economy? What is this called? What happens to prices when there is a small amount of money in the economy? What is this called?
Why did farmers want more money in circulation? How would they benefit?	

THE POPULIST PARTY PLATFORM The economic reforms proposed by the Populists included an increase in the money supply. This would produce a rise in prices received for goods and services. The Populists also wanted bank regulation, a graduated income tax, and a federal loan program. They further called for government ownership and regulation of railroad and telegraph companies. The proposed governmental reforms included the election of U.S. senators by popular vote, single terms for the president and the vice-president, and a secret ballot to end voter fraud. Finally, the Populists called for an eight-hour workday and restrictions on immigration. The proposed changes were so attractive to struggling farmers and desperate laborers that in 1892 the Populist presidential candidate won almost 10 percent of the total vote. In the West, the People's Party elected 5 senators, 3 governors, and about 1,500 state legislators. The Populists' programs eventually became the platform of the Democratic Party. Populists kept alive the concept that the government is responsible for reforming social injustices.	What changes did the Populist Party want to make in America?
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Silverites

- Farmers, laborers
- South & West
- Democrats
- Bimetallism-silver & gold to back money supply
- Print more money (increase supply)
- Stimulate the economy

Goldbugs

- Business & Industrial
- Northeast
- Republicans
- Gold Standard: only use gold to back money supply
- More stable



People regarded paper \$ as worthless if it couldn't be turned in for coin

What does a “silverite” want?

What is Bimetallism?

What does a “gold bug” want?

BRYAN AND THE “CROSS OF GOLD” Stepping into the debate, the Populist Party called for bimetallism and free coinage of silver. Yet their strategy was undecided: should they join forces with sympathetic candidates in the major parties and risk losing their political identity? Or should they nominate their own candidates and risk losing the election?

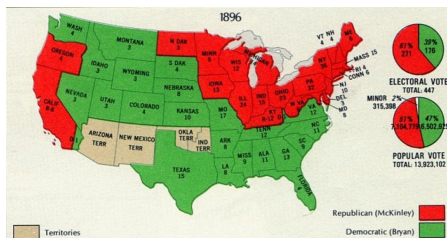
As the 1896 campaign progressed, the Republican Party stated its firm commitment to the gold standard and nominated Ohioan **William McKinley** for president. After much debate, the Democratic Party came out in favor of a combined gold and silver standard. This included unlimited coinage of silver. At the Democratic convention, former Nebraska congressman **William Jennings Bryan**, editor of the *Omaha World-Herald*, delivered an impassioned address to the assembled delegates. This speech has become known as the “Cross of Gold” speech

Bryan won the Democratic nomination. When the Populist convention met two weeks later, the delegates were both pleased and frustrated. They liked Bryan and the Democratic platform, but they detested the Democratic vice-presidential candidate, Maine banker Arthur Sewall. Nor did they like giving up their identity as a party. They compromised by endorsing Bryan, but nominating their own candidate, Thomas Watson of Georgia, for vice-president. The Populists kept their party organization intact.

What Party and candidate wanted the gold standard?

What Party and candidate wanted Bimetallism?

What convinced the Democratic convention to nominate William Jennings Bryan for president?



- City dwellers (industry) were afraid of inflation-overwhelmingly voted for McKinley

- McKinley won the election 7 million to Bryan's 6.5 million
- McKinley carried the East & urban Midwest
- Bryan carried the South and farm West—agriculture

Failed to win elections, but many of their goals do happen in the 20th Century

What was the most important issue in the election?

Who wins the election?

What happens to the Populist Party as a result of the election?